



Figure 8: Transformation tools

provides you the exact colour code for the selected colour (something like #FG34B3). You can also set the selected colour to foreground/background colour swatches from the settings.

- **Zoom:** This tool lets you zoom in and out of the images, providing the zoom level according to your resolution and workspace.

The Measure and Alignment tools

The next set, Measure and Alignment tools, are mediocre and hardly come into play, except for the **Move** tool. The set begins with the **Measure** tool that lets you measure the distance between two desired points. Just drag and leave it; the tool will display the dimensions in the lower part of the GIMP near the **Zoom** tool.

This set also comes with the **Alignment** tool that lets you easily align the selected part of the image to a pre-set desired area. Just select the alignment area, and that part of the image will be moved into the same position.

The **Crop** tool lets you crop an image. I generally don't use this tool and prefer the rectangular selection tool to achieve similar results.

Transformation tools

This very powerful set of tools provides arrays of effects, letting you create wonderful effects with a few simple clicks. Some of the tools let you create 3D effects in a 2D raster image editor (refer to Figure 8).

- **Rotate:** This lets you rotate the image 360 degrees. Select the tool and click on the image, then move the image in a clockwise or anti-clockwise direction to rotate it [Image 1, Figure 8].
- **Scale:** Scaling images has never been so easy; you don't have to mug up any resolutions—just drag the image to gain the final output with the new resolution/size [Image 2, Figure 8].
- **Shear:** Shear moves one part of the image, making the image a bit inclined. It distorts the image by changing its nature or type. To use it, just select the tool and click on the image. Then move the mouse left or right by holding the left mouse button, and shear as you want to [Image 3, Figure 8].
- **Perspective:** This is another tool that I like to use a

lot. **Perspective** gives a 3D look to an image—you can easily change the way it looks. Effects like **Flip Switch**, **Cover flow**, etc., can be achieved using this tool. It works in the same way other **Transformation** tools do [Image 4, Figure 8].

- **Flip:** This tool flips the image either diagonally or vertically. Just select the tool and click on the image to flip it [Image 5, Figure 8].



Note: Unlike other transformation tools, the **Flip** tool does not provide a preview, but directly applies the changes. In order to undo the changes, press **CTRL+Z**.

- **Text:** This lets you add text to an image. It, however, only allows you to add simple text to an image, though you can change fonts and size as per your needs. To add special text effects, we must resort to other GIMP tools and options.

The Colour and Drawing tools

These are similar to what we use in real life—a pencil, colour box, eraser, dropper and brushes. The only difference is the 'gradient'. I will include colour swatches in this section, which is reminiscent of the square-shaped colour cubes that are generally used in Indian schools.

- **Bucket fill:** Everyone who has used a computer will be aware of this tool. The most common tool that newbies start playing with is **Bucket fill**, a basic necessity for any image editor available off-the-shelf. Apart from filling normal colours/patterns, it also allows you to provide a pre-set colour effect to the filled colour. You can change options easily from the **Tools** section.
- **Blend tool/Gradient:** This is not just another paint fill tool. The beauty of this tool is that it lets you provide a cool blend of multiple colours. The blend can also be considered as a first step to creating high-end wallpaper. There are a number of integrated options available under the **Tools** menu, allowing you to create assorted effects with just a click. To apply the **gradient**, set any two colours in the colour swatches and while retaining the left click, drag a line in the worksheet. Leave it once you've got the desired direction for the gradient effect.



Tips: Though **Bucket fill** is the preferred tool to fill in colour, to save time, you can just drag and drop colour from the colour swatches. Make sure you are on the correct layer and the selection is active.